

Video Game Sales Analysis (1980-2020)

Global Trends by Genre, Platform & Publisher · Tools: Google Sheets (pivot tables, charts) · Dataset: Kaggle Video Game Sales

Overview

This project analyzes a dataset of 16,500+ video game sales records to explore trends in the gaming industry by genre, platform, publisher, and time. The goal was to practice real-world data cleaning and analysis skills while answering specific, business-relevant questions.

1. Which genre had the highest total global sales?

Using a pivot table, I found that **Action games led all genres with 8,920.44 million** in global sales. This matters because it shows publishers and platforms where to prioritize development investment.

2. How have total sales trended over time?

Global sales grew steadily through the 1990s and 2000s, **peaked around 2008-2009 (~680M)** near the height of the console era, then declined — likely tied to the industry's shift toward mobile and digital distribution.

Note: data coverage drops sharply after 2016, so 2017-2020 reflect incomplete records rather than an actual sales collapse.

3. Which platform and publisher had the highest total sales — and do they match?

PS2 led all individual platforms. However, **Nintendo led all publishers overall.**

This isn't a contradiction — Nintendo's sales are aggregated across many consoles spanning decades (NES through Switch-era), while PS2's total reflects just one console's lifetime. This distinction highlights the difference between platform-level and publisher-level analysis.

Key Takeaways

Action is the dominant genre by sales; the industry's growth peaked with the console era before the shift to digital; and sales leadership looks different depending on whether you measure by platform or by publisher — a reminder to be precise about what question you're actually answering.